Minjia Fu

PhD Student in Economics

ENS de Lyon | CERGIC | e0540014@u.nus.edu | morsefmj718.github.io

Research Interests

Economic Geography; Spatial Inequality; Urban Economics; Transport Economics; Political Economy

Education

ENS de Lyon October 2026-present
PhD in Economics, CERGIC *Supervisor: Prof. Florence Goffette-Nagot*

Erasmus Mundus Joint Master in Models and Methods of Quantitative Economics 2024-2026
Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne, UCLouvain, and Paris School of Economics *Completed 2026*
M2 in Analysis and Policy in Economics, jointly with Paris School of Economics.

National University of Singapore 2020-2024
BSc Honours in Applied Mathematics *Second Major in Economics; Minor in French Studies*
Specialisation in Mathematical Modelling and Data Analytics.

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Social Ties Project 1 July-30 September 2026
Hugo Subtil *Finished position*

- Constructed and harmonised French electoral datasets across elections and geographic units, documenting coverage, identifiers, and data-quality issues.
- Developed reproducible workflows for political text data, distinguishing shared or template material from candidate-specific content.
- Prepared exploratory analyses and validation procedures for constructed measures.

Research Assistant, Paris School of Economics July 2025-April 2026
Media Citations and the Rana Plaza Event *Supervisor: Prof. Pamina Koenig*

- Built workflows to collect, clean, and classify multilingual media coverage of multinational brands from Factiva archives.
- Used R and Python for automated text processing, entity disambiguation, and article-relevance classification.

Research Assistant, HKUST Guangzhou July-September 2025
Rare Earth and Critical Mineral Projects *Supervisor: Asst. Prof. Yangsiyu Lu*

- Constructed a verified database of projects and ownership from government, industry, firm-level, and geospatial sources.
- Conducted preliminary geospatial analysis of mine and processing-facility locations.

Research Assistant, Centre for Music and Health, NUS May-June 2024
Live versus prerecorded music research with dialysis patients *Supervisor: Asst. Prof. Kat Agres*

- Supported consent, surveys, and fieldwork at two dialysis centres and prepared research materials for field use.

Teaching Experience

Co-instructor, Topics in Microeconomics M2 Semester 1, 2026-2027
ENS de Lyon *With Alex Newnham*
Responsible for approximately half of the course, focusing on transport, spatial inequality, and demographic change.
Session 1: *Building Networks and Making Places: Can transport infrastructure create growth and new centres?*

Research Projects

Master's Thesis January-June 2026
Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne and Paris School of Economics *Supervisor: Prof. Camille Hémet*
The Political Consequences of Infrastructure Withdrawal: Electoral Effects of Railway Station Closures in France

- Combined historical railway-station data, electoral returns, commune characteristics, and accessibility measures to study station access and French electoral outcomes in the late 1960s and early 1970s.
- Used controlled first-difference models, diagnostic tests, and an instrumental-variable strategy; the completed thesis does not claim definitive causal findings.

Advanced Microeconometrics Project, Paris School of Economics September-December 2025
The Survival of French Railway Stations *Station-age duration analysis*

- Modelled railway station closures as a time-to-event process using Kaplan-Meier, time-varying Cox, and Gompertz specifications.

Honours Thesis, National University of Singapore 2023-2024
Hypergraph and its application in Transport Network Modelling *Supervisor: Assoc. Prof. Fei Han*

- Developed hypergraph-based measures of trip efficiency and network robustness and conducted vulnerability simulations for transport planning.

Research Paper, UCLouvain May 2025
Critical Assessment of Singapore's Pension System *Course research paper*
Assessed the sustainability and adequacy of Singapore's Central Provident Fund and compared it with OECD pension systems.

Technical and Language Skills

Programming Python, R, Stata
Languages English; Mandarin (native); French (B2)